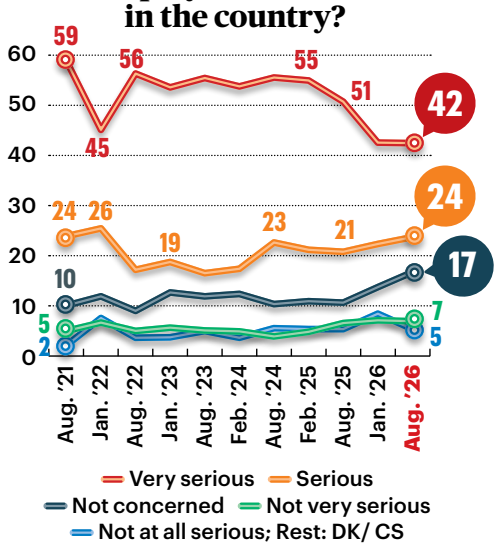


TOUGH EXERCISE A physical examination of the army's Agniveer aspirants

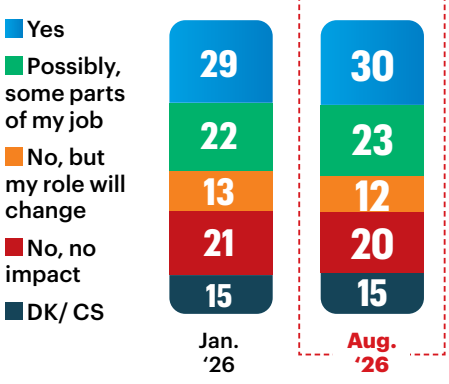
ANI

Q. How do you view the unemployment situation in the country?



Overall public concern over unemployment has gone up

Q. Do you think AI will take away your job?



Fears of job losses due to AI remain unchanged from the previous poll

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

THE JOBS CRISIS

The recent Gen Z protests across the country, demanding greater accountability from the government in education and examinations, have also brought the jobs question to the fore. India has more than 367 million young people aged 15-29, the largest youth population in the world. Between 2022 and 2025, the share of young people in this age group with secondary or higher education rose from 56.5 per cent to 62.6 per cent. But higher education levels have not translated into better jobs.

Youth unemployment stands at 10 per cent, three times the overall unemployment rate. This is because only 42.6 per cent of Indian graduates are employable, according to jobs consultancy Mercer, highlighting the skills deficit among the country's youth. This gap could widen as the rapid adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) reshapes jobs across industries.

It is no wonder then that 66.1 per cent of those polled describe the employment situation as either 'very serious' or 'serious', up from 64.8 per cent in January. Yet, some 17 per cent do not see the jobs crisis as a serious concern. The threat from AI is more tangible, with 53 per cent saying it could either take away their jobs or replace some of the tasks they perform.

A sizeable section of respondents wants businesses freed from government interference, with 40.6 per cent saying the government has no business being in business. Another 36.8 per cent favour disinvestment in loss-making public sector firms, believing this could unlock their potential. And, for 34.6 per cent, bureaucracy remains a 'hindrance' to the country's economic development.

The message from the MOTN poll is not that growth has failed, but that its benefits have yet to percolate deeper. For the government, the challenge now is to turn a strong macroeconomic story into one that is visible in household incomes, jobs and everyday lives. ■

66
PER CENT
of those polled say the employment situation is either 'very serious' or 'serious'